



[Eng Announce] Unity AI Gateway is now Generally Available 🎉

3 messages

David Nasi <david.nasi@databricks.com>

4 August 2026 at 23:51

To: eng-announce <eng-announce@databricks.com>, prod-staff <product-staff@databricks.com>, Market-Info <market-info@databricks.com>

Hi all,

🎉 Unity AI Gateway is now Generally Available!

Unity AI Gateway is already in use by over 3K customers, including Asana, Block, Standard Chartered, General Motors, and others. It gives customers the cost, control, and choice levers they need to manage AI spend and enforce governance across AI agents and assets, including models, coding agents, MCPs, external agents, and skills.

💡 Why it matters

As customers scale AI adoption, they face growing sprawl of models, tools, and agents. Different teams want to use different models, coding agents, MCP servers, and capacity providers. Without a common control plane, managing access, understanding costs, and retaining accountability for agent actions becomes difficult.

Unity AI Gateway brings **Choice, Cost, and Control** together. Customers can preserve an open, multi-AI strategy while applying consistent governance.

✅ What is GA

- **Choice:** Give teams governed access to Databricks-hosted partner and open-source models, including GPT-5.6, GLM 5.2, and Kimi K3. Customers can also bring capacity from external providers such as Amazon Bedrock and Azure.
- **Cost:** See, control, and reduce AI spend. Customers get an out-of-the-box dashboard and granular system tables to understand usage and attribute costs by user, team, model, and use case. They can configure spend alerts and hard caps for supported Databricks-hosted traffic.
- **Control:** Use Unity Catalog permissions to govern which users and agents can invoke each model, MCP service, and tool. Customers can define services once and apply access controls consistently across workspaces.

Production availability: Ring 2 and Ring 3 customers no longer need to opt in. Unity AI Gateway is enabled by default. Ring 1 customers can opt in.

Importantly, **CSP and HIPAA workspaces can now use Unity AI Gateway!** CSP customers can opt in during the next 30 days. After that period, CSP workspaces will be enrolled automatically.

🔧 Available in Beta or coming next

- **Smart Routing, available in Beta (new!):** Automatically select the right model and agent harness based on the task, complexity, permissions, and budget. This helps customers shift routine work to lower-cost models while reserving frontier models for complex tasks, with every routing decision visible and auditable.
- **Service Policies and Guardrails, available in Beta:** Allow, deny, or require approval for model and MCP interactions. Customers can apply built-in guardrails such as PII redaction, define custom guardrails using code or LLM-as-a-judge, and integrate external guardrail providers.
- **Public APIs and Terraform support, available in Beta:** Provision and manage AI Gateway resources through APIs, the Databricks CLI, and Terraform. This enables GitOps and CI/CD workflows for models, providers, MCP services, and other governed AI assets.
- **Unified tracing, rolling out in Beta later this week:** Opt into a centralized Unity Catalog trace table containing model and MCP interactions, including request and response content. Customers can use this for debugging, abuse detection, and security and compliance monitoring.
- **ABAC GRANT policies, targeting August 10:** Scale model permissions through attribute-based policies instead of managing one-off grants.
- **External-model cost controls, targeting approximately August 15:** Extend usage visibility, budgets, and hard caps to externally hosted models as well as Databricks-hosted models.

Normal roadmap caveats apply to all forward-looking dates.

Call to action

- **Lead with coding agents.** They are the fastest path to demonstrating the value of governing high-volume, multi-model AI usage through Unity AI Gateway.
- **Get educated:** Use [go/aigovernance](https://go.aigovernance) for L100/L200 decks, demos, competitive resources, a brand new demo, and other enablement material.
- **Help customers get started:** Review the [product documentation](#), [GA blog](#), [API documentation](#), and [FAQ](#).
- **Bring back feedback:** Log blockers and friction in Brickroad, and use [#aigateway](#) for questions and feedback.

Recognition

A huge THANK YOU to everyone who contributed to this milestone!

- **Leadership:** Matei Zaharia, Aaron Davidson, Martin Grund, Akhil Gupta, Michalis Petropoulos, Kasey Uhlenhuth
- **Core engineering:** Kevin Stumpf, Sven Wagner-Boysen, Vladimir Kolovski, Sunish Sheth, David Lewis, Akhil Gudesu, Eddie Bkheet, Mingyu Li, Khoo Qi Xuan, Anusha Kansal, Bill Wang, Tony Cai, Rohit Agrawal, Shaotong Li, Arthur Jenoudet, Anastasiia Terenteva, Xi Lyu, David Liu, Zack Siegel, Nisha Balaji, Alex Khakhlyuk, Daniel Seong, Jingchen Tang, Max Rozen, Makoto Raku, Tien Le, Mason Cao, Javeed Shaikh, Cheng Lian, Alicia Chen, Alkis Polyzotis, Sue Ann Hong, Bryan McQuade, Will Zhang, Rohan Potru, Shuyu Cao
- **Product and program:** Stefania Leone, Jakob Mund, Achille Negrier, Ahmed Bilal, Soumik Paul, Hannah Vergara, Thomas Houit, Adriana Ispas, Elise Gonzales, Archika Dogra
- **Product Marketing and Field:** Kelly Albano, Tim Lortz, Cynthia Peranandam
- **Design and docs:** Ridhima Gupta, Nina Baccam, David Peter Hansen

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5 August 2026 at 00:24

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5 August 2026 at 23:00

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On Tue, Aug 4, 2026 at 2:51 PM David Nasi <david.nasi@databricks.com> wrote:

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